WASTE CLASSIFICATION

Reference Guide

A Comprehensive 200-Item Guide for

Proper Waste Segregation and Disposal

Plastic • Paper • Organic • Metal & Glass

E-Waste • Sanitary & Household

Professional Edition | 2024

Introduction

This comprehensive reference guide provides detailed classification information for 200 common household and commercial waste items. Proper waste segregation is essential for effective recycling, reducing landfill burden, and protecting our environment.

How to Use This Guide

Each waste item is classified according to the following criteria:

Column	Description
Item Name	The common name of the waste item
Image Placeholder	Visual reference location for the item
Bin Type	Recommended bin colour for disposal
Category	Waste classification category
Recyclability	Whether the item can be recycled
Biodegradability	Whether the item decomposes naturally
Disposal Instructions	Brief guidance for proper disposal

Bin Colour Guide

Colour	Bin Type	Waste Category
Yellow	Recycling Bin	Recyclable materials
Blue	Paper Bin	Paper and cardboard
Green	Organic Bin	Compostable waste
Red	Hazardous Bin	Dangerous materials
Grey	General Waste	Non-recyclable refuse

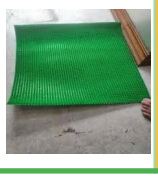
1. Plastic & Polystyrene

This section contains 40 items.

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Milk Pouches		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse and flatten before recycling
Shampoo Bottles		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty, rinse, replace cap
Detergent Cans		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse thoroughly, crush if possible
Bubble Wrap		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse if possible, else recycle
PET Bottles		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty, crush, replace cap
Plastic Spoons		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean before recycling
Straws		Grey	Plastic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Polythene Bags		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Bundle together, recycle
PVC Pipes		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to recycling centre

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Plastic Toys		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Donate if usable, else recycle
Yogurt Tubs		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse clean before recycling
Takeaway Containers		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean thoroughly first
Cling Film		Grey	Plastic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Plastic Caps		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Leave on bottles or separate
Toothbrush		Grey	Plastic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Soap Case		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean before recycling
Comb		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with hard plastics
Plastic Buckets		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse or recycle
Ball Pens		Grey	Plastic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste

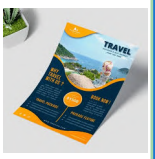
Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
CD Cases		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Remove paper inserts first
Plastic Jars		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse and recycle
Medicine Blister Packs		Grey	Plastic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Return to pharmacy
Carry Bags		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse, then recycle
Zip-lock Bags		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean and dry before recycling
Plastic Plates		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean thoroughly
Disposable Cups		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty and rinse
Ice-cream Tubs		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse clean before recycling
Sauce Bottles		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse, replace cap
Oil Cans		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty completely, rinse
Plastic Hangers		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Donate or recycle

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Tiffin Boxes		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean before recycling
Spray Bottles		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty, remove trigger
Bubble Mailers		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Remove labels, recycle
Thermocol Sheets		Yellow	Polystyrene	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to recycling centre
Foam Cups		Yellow	Polystyrene	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean before recycling
Plastic Furniture		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to recycling centre
Crates		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Return to supplier or recycle
Cosmetic Tubes		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty, rinse, recycle
Lamination Sheets		Grey	Plastic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Plastic Mats		Yellow	Plastic	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean and recycle

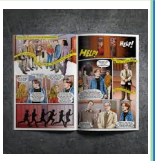
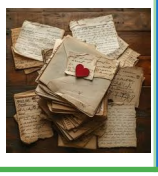
2. Paper & Cardboard

This section contains 40 items.

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Newspaper		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Keep dry and clean
Magazines		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove plastic wrap
Office Paper		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove staples, clips
Envelopes		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove plastic windows
Cereal Boxes		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Flatten, remove liner
Egg Cartons (Paper)		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Flatten before recycling
Shredded Paper		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Bag separately
Notebooks		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove metal spiral
Greeting Cards		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove embellishments
Post-it Notes		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Recycle with paper

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Pizza Boxes (Clean)		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	No grease or food residue
Wrapping Paper		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove tape, bows
Cardboard Tubes		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Flatten for recycling
Paper Bags		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove handles first
Flyers		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Keep clean and dry
Catalogues		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove plastic wrap
Phone Books		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Recycle whole
Receipts		Grey	Paper	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Thermal paper - general waste
Tissue Paper		Green	Paper	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost if clean
Paper Napkins		Green	Paper	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost if unsoiled
Cardboard Inserts		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Flatten before recycling

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Shoe Boxes		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove labels, flatten
Shipping Labels		Grey	Paper	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Calendars		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove metal spiral
Paper Plates		Green	Paper	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost if uncoated
Posters		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove tape, backing
Sketchbooks		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove binding
File Folders		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove metal tabs
Index Cards		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Recycle with paper
Milk Cartons (Tetra)		Blue	Composite	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse, flatten, recycle
Juice Boxes		Blue	Composite	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse and flatten
Paper Cup Sleeves		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Separate from cup

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Gift Boxes		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove ribbons, tape
Tissue Boxes		Blue	Cardboard	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove plastic film
Bookmark		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Recycle with paper
Map Paper		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Keep dry
Comic Books		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Donate if collectible
Scrap Paper		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Recycle all scraps
Paper Tags		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove strings first
Old Letters		Blue	Paper	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove plastic windows

3. Organic & Kitchen Waste

This section contains 40 items.

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Apple Core		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost in organic bin
Orange Peels		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost with other scraps
Vegetable Trimmings		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost all trimmings
Eggshells		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Crush before composting
Coffee Grounds		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Excellent for compost
Tea Bags		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Remove staples first
Leftover Rice		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost in organic bin
Bread Crusts		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost or feed birds
Spoiled Milk		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Pour into organic bin
Nut Shells		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Crush for faster composting

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Used Flowers		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost garden waste
Dry Leaves		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Use as mulch or compost
Grass Clippings		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost or use as mulch
Plant Stems		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Cut before composting
Meat Scraps		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Bury deep in compost
Fish Bones		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost carefully
Fruit Seeds		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost with fruit waste
Corn Cobs		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Break into pieces
Onion Skins		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost with vegetables
Garlic Husks		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Add to compost
Rotten Fruits		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost in organic bin
Stale Bread		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost or feed wildlife

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Pizza Crust		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost food waste
Potato Peels		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost vegetable scraps
Matchsticks		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Ensure extinguished
Toothpicks		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost wood items
Prawn Shells		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Bury in compost
Expired Flour		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost dry goods
Used Cooking Oil		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Collect for recycling
Coconut Husks		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Break down first
Sugarcane Waste		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost fibrous waste
Spent Grains		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Excellent compost material
Vegetable Soup		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Pour into organic bin

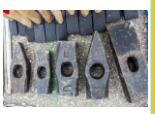
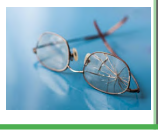
Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Fruit Pulp		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost fruit waste
Indoor Plant Waste		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost plant trimmings
Straw/Hay		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Use as garden mulch
Animal Fur		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost pet hair
Sawdust		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost untreated wood
Feathers		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Bury in compost
Cotton Balls		Green	Organic	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Compost if pure cotton

4. Metal & Glass

This section contains 30 items.

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Soda Cans		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse, crush if possible
Tin Canned Food		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty, rinse, no lids
Aluminium Foil		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean, scrunch into ball
Metal Lids		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with metal
Rusted Nails		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Collect in container
Paper Clips		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse or recycle
Safety Pins		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse if possible
Copper Wires		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to scrap dealer
Iron Rods		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to metal recycler
Metal Hangers		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Return to dry cleaners
Glass Water Bottles		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse, remove caps
Jam Jars		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse, remove labels

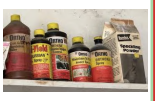
Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Wine Bottles		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse, leave caps off
Perfume Bottles		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty completely
Broken Glass		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap safely, label
Mirror Pieces		Grey	Glass	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap, dispose carefully
Glass Bowls		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Donate if usable
Window Glass		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to recycling centre
Metal Caps		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with metal
Utensils		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Donate if usable
Metal Keys		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with metal
Screws		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Collect in container
Aluminium Trays		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Clean before recycling
Empty Paint Tins		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Must be completely dry
Steel Scrubber		Grey	Metal	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Metal Chains		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with scrap metal

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Hammer Heads		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to metal recycler
Brass Items		Yellow	Metal	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Valuable scrap metal
Beverage Glass		Yellow	Glass	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Rinse before recycling
Spectacle Lenses		Grey	Glass	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Return to optician

5. E-Waste & Hazardous Materials

This section contains 25 items.

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Remote Controls		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to e-waste centre
Keyboards		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle at e-waste facility
Mouse		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to e-waste centre
USB Cables		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with e-waste
Phone Chargers		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to e-waste centre
Old Earphones		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle at e-waste facility
Laptop Batteries		Red	Hazardous	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Never dispose in bins
AA/AAA Batteries		Red	Hazardous	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Use battery recycling
LED Bulbs		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Handle carefully
Tube Lights		Red	Hazardous	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Contains mercury
Old Smartphones		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Delete data first
Calculators		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Remove batteries first
Motherboards		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to e-waste centre

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Hard Drives		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Destroy data first
Smartwatches		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with e-waste
Electric Kettle		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to recycling centre
Hair Dryers		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle at e-waste facility
Iron		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Take to e-waste centre
Pesticide Bottles		Red	Hazardous	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Triple rinse, dispose safely
Paint Cans		Red	Hazardous	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Must be empty and dry
Cleaning Chemicals		Red	Hazardous	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Never pour down drain
Printer Cartridges		Red	Hazardous	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Return to manufacturer
Old Routers		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reset before recycling
CD/DVDs		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Recycle with e-waste
Electric Wires		Red	E-Waste	Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Strip copper if possible

6. Sanitary & Household Refuse

This section contains 25 items.

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Used Masks		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in sealed bag
Diapers		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap and seal tightly
Sanitary Pads		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap in paper, dispose
Wet Wipes		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Never flush, bin only
Dust from Sweeping		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Vacuum Cleaner Dust		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty into general waste
Human Hair		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Cigarette Butts		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Extinguish completely
Used Bandages		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap before disposing
Cotton Buds		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Never flush down toilet
Old Sponges		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Worn-out Shoes		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Donate if repairable
Torn Clothes		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Donate to textile banks

Item Name	Image	Bin Type	Category	Recyclable	Biodegradable	Instructions
Rags		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Reuse as cleaning rags
Broken Ceramics		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap carefully, dispose
Styrofoam Peanuts		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse packaging material
Candy Wrappers		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Chip Packets		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Empty before disposing
Used Condoms		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap and bin, never flush
Pet Litter		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Bag and seal tightly
Disposable Razors		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Wrap blade carefully
Used Tissues		Grey	Sanitary	Non-Recyclable	Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste
Old Wallets		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Donate if usable
Rubber Bands		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Reuse or dispose
Umbrella Fabric		Grey	Household	Non-Recyclable	Non-Biodegradable	Dispose in general waste